



UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

COPY EDITING CONTEST

INVITATIONAL A 2026

This test is produced, and should be graded,
using the 2024-2026 Associated Press Stylebook, 57th edition,
in print or updated on or before June 1, 2024, online.

Students may use the AP Stylebook, dictionary and/or thesaurus
during the exam.

FOR JUDGE'S USE

Points from
PART 1

Points from
PART 2

TOTAL
POINTS

POINTS/15

POINTS/20

POINTS/35

PLACE

PART 3
is graded
ONLY
to break ties.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO!

RECOMMENDED EDITING MARKS

Students should use clearly understood editing symbols.

Students will NOT be penalized for using other symbols.

It is up to the judges to determine if marks are “clearly understood.”

¶ or L

¶ Leaguetown High School will undergo renovations this summer. ¶ “This is long overdue,” Principal Mike Macall said.
“I’m so glad to see it’s finally happening.”

indent for paragraph

paragraph

no paragraph

⤿

His complaints are just grapes sour.

transpose

○

They’ve been married eleven years.

use figures

She lives in Austin, TX.

spell out

○

Superintendent Lyle Keen addressed the school board

abbreviate

Jr. Joe Smith can’t wait until he’s a senior.

don’t abbreviate

≡

I love my english class.

uppercase

/

High School can be fun and interesting.

lowercase

⌒

Happy Thanks giving!

remove space

└┐

When his family moves, he will have to change high schools.

insert space

STET

He uses ^{STET} two pencils for tests.

ignore correction

↯

I can’t wait for that the movie to come out.

delete

↗

insert comma

↘

insert apostrophe

↕

insert quotation marks

⊙ ⊗

insert period

≡

insert hyphen

↖

insert dash

COPY EDITING CONTEST

Invitational A

DIRECTIONS: This test is divided into three sections. All three sections are mandatory. Write all your responses as indicated. You have 15 minutes.

PART 1: Circle the correct response. (1 pt. each)

1. The recipe calls for **two** / **2** cups of flour and a teaspoon of vanilla.
2. Let's have a picnic since **it's** / **its** such a lovely day.
3. He moved to Sante Fe, **NM** / **New Mexico**, last year.
4. I hate to hear **youre** / **your** / **you're** going to miss the party.
5. He is planning to host a party next **Sat.** / **Saturday**.
6. We won't have school on **Presidents Day** / **President's Day** / **Presidents' Day**.
7. The **Federal Government** / **federal government** consists of three branches.
8. None of the dogs **are** / **is** ready to be adopted.
9. He wants to be a **sports writer** / **sportswriter** one day.
10. I love **honeycrisp** / **Honeycrisp** apples because they are so sweet.
11. Her counselor **advised** / **advised** her to apply for college.
12. His **recurring** / **reoccurring** nightmare woke him repeatedly.
13. The **site** / **cite** / **sight** of the crime was cordoned off.
14. They found they were a **compatable** / **compatible** couple.
15. His **acknowledgment** / **acknowledgement** of her work made her day.

TOTAL ____/15

UIL COPY EDITING INVITATIONAL A 2026

PART 2: Edit the following sentences to eliminate/correct **FOUR** (and only four) errors in wordiness, AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation in each of the five statements below. Use clearly understood editing symbols. Spelling errors should be corrected, not simply marked for correction. Judges will only evaluate the first four corrections the contestant makes. Judges will ignore any additional corrections beyond the first four. Contestants will receive points for correct edits but will not receive points if they miss a correction, include unnecessary corrections or use unclear editing symbols. Compound errors such as changing “First Lady” to “first lady” will be considered as one error. (4 pts. each)

POINTS

- | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1. Beverly used post-it notes to mark vocabulary words in the novel she was

reading for english class. She liked to use study aides whenever possibly. |
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 2. He said, he felt murphy’s law was begining to dictate his life as his house was

being built. The many problems the builders facet never seemed to end. |
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 3. It takes about 4 hours to drive to my home town. I hate the drive but I love

to catching up with my family and old friends. |
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 4. She hopes to be editor in chief of the newspaper her Senior year. She’s

been a reporter and a News editor, and said she is ready for more responsibility. |
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5. Did you know president Harry S. Truman didn’t have a middle name. His

grandfathers had names with an S, so the initial was to honour them. |

TOTAL

_____/20

UIL COPY EDITING INVITATIONAL A 2026

PART 3: In the space provided, edit the following news brief to make the wording clear, to eliminate wordiness as well as any errors in AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation. You do NOT have to rewrite the news brief. Make notes of anything you believe needs clarification, additional research or additional reporting. **PART 3 WILL BE USED ONLY TO BREAK TIES BUT IS REQUIRED.** In the event of a tie, if you do not make any effort on Part 3, your entire entry will be **DISQUALIFIED** from the entire contest.

On the 26st of September, Mitch Mills of the Leaguetown High School Science Department led a trip for his classes to hike in the Davis Mountains.

Mills brought students in his geology class to present facts about the mountain to students in his earth science classes. There were a total of 36 students in attendance along with Nancy Wellington and Tom Smith, who were chaperones.

Wellington courageously led the first group up the mountain.

“After about a quater of a mile, 2 students turned back because of the difficult terrain. Another student hurt their knee, but overall the students did well on the hike,” Wellington said.

Several students said they enjoyed learning about the mountain away from school.

“It was fun to learn about the terrain and the types of rocks,” sophomore April Majors said. “It was also nice to have a day off from school.”

Afterward, students were rewarded with snacks from the local store and happily set off for home. Ms. Wellington stated “the hike afforded students a wonderful opportunity to face their fears, and learn about science. We all enjoyed the trip.”

COPY EDITING CONTEST INVITATIONAL A 2026

ANSWER KEY

PART I

1. 2
2. it's
3. New Mexico
4. you're
5. Saturday
6. Presidents Day
7. federal government
8. is
9. sports writer
10. Honeycrisp
11. advised
12. recurring
13. site
14. compatible
15. acknowledgment

PART 2

1. Beverly used post-it notes to mark vocabulary words in the novel she was reading for english class. She liked to use study aides whenever possibly ever.
2. He said, he felt murphy's law was beginning to dictate his life as his house was being built. The many problems the builders faced never seemed to end.
3. It takes about 4 hours to drive to my home town. I hate the drive but I love to catching up with my family and old friends.
4. She hopes to be editor in chief of the newspaper her senior year. She's been a reporter and a news editor and said she is ready for more responsibility.
5. Did you know president Harry S. Truman didn't have a middle name His grandfathers had names with an S, so the initial was used to honour them.

NOTE TO JUDGES

Sentence 3 could read "catching up" or "to catch up."

UIL COPY EDITING INVITATIONAL A 2026

PART 3: In the space provided, edit the following news brief to make the wording clear and to eliminate wordiness as well as any errors in AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation. You do NOT have to rewrite the news brief. Make notes of anything you believe needs clarification, additional research or additional reporting. PART 3 WILL BE USED ONLY TO BREAK TIES BUT IS REQUIRED. In the event of a tie, if you do not make any effort on Part 3, your entire entry will be DISQUALIFIED from the entire contest.

You are editing for the Oct. 3 issue of the Leaguetown School Press in Leaguetown, Texas.

NOTES TO JUDGES

This section is ranked to break a tie in the combined scores of parts 1 and 2. Assign no points.

Judges should compare the papers of students who tied, ranking them accordingly.

When judging Part 3, holistically read the changes the student indicated starting with the highest level of editing.

- Highest level: Are there any legal or ethical issues with the story?

- Middle level: Does the story use the right sources? Does it flow?

- Lowest level: Grammar, spelling, punctuation, style.

..

Part 3

¶1 — Avoid beginning with the date. He is a science teacher at your school, so you don't need the long description.

¶2 — The second sentence needs to be more concise.

¶3 — "Courageously" is opinion.

¶4 — Attribution should be after first sentence of quote.

¶5 — Avoid vague words such as "several" and "many."

¶7 — Avoid passive voice. You don't know where everyone went or whether they were happy.

Quotes are separate paragraphs. Use said, not stated.

Science teacher

On the 26th of September, Mitch Mills of the Leaguetown High School Science

took

Sept. 26

Department led a trip for his classes to hike in the Davis Mountains.

Mills brought students in his geology class to present facts about the

Thirty-six

mountain to students in his earth science classes. There were a total of 36 students in

attended

chaperones

attendance along with Nancy Wellington and Tom Smith, who were chaperones.

Wellington courageously led the first group up the mountain.

"After about a quarter of a mile, 2 students turned back because of the difficult

" Wellington said. "

terrain. Another student hurt their knee, but overall the students did well on the

hike." Wellington said.

Sophomore April Majors said she

Several students said they enjoyed learning about the mountain away from school.

"It was fun to learn about the terrain and the types of rocks," sophomore April

Majors said. "It was also nice to have a day off from school."

received

Afterward, students were rewarded with snacks from the local store and happily

set off for home. Ms. Wellington stated "the hike afforded students a wonderful

" Wellington said. "

opportunity to face their fears, and learn about science. We all enjoyed the trip."